Westbrook School Committee

~ School Committee Meeting ~

Date: Wednesday, April 8, 2026
Time: 7:00 PM
Location: Westbrook High School (Room 114), 117 Stroudwater St. (Hybrid via Zoom)
Video: https://vimeo.com/1181369392
Packet: https://drive.google.com/file/d/1a13Tye5X1_USLQu0B2nspD70EP7W33cE/view (Google Drive, via westbrookschools.org)

Timestamps below are clickable [0:00]-style links — they jump straight to that moment in the video.

This summary highlights the meeting's key discussions and decisions, with direct quotes and timestamps for verification — it is not a substitute for watching the full meeting. *The full committee (all seven members) and both student representatives were present. A brief 5:00 PM Finance Committee session immediately preceded this meeting (see the companion summary). For complete context, nuance, and anything not covered, watch the full video at the link above. (Produced by: WestbrookCurrents.com)*

Superintendent's Report

Retirements & Student/Program Recognitions [7:20]

Discussion Summary

Dr. Lancia announced three retirements: Paula Curcio (WMS social studies teacher), Marina Davis (WHS math teacher), and Wendy Harvey (WHS co-principal, after 12 years as assistant and co-principal). He recognized extensive achievements: 35 WRVC students at the SkillsUSA state championships with multiple medalists; the WRVC/WHS eSports team's two state championship titles; a Junior Achievement Titan Challenge state title (unseating a longtime Yarmouth High School streak); WHS Winter Guard's top-Maine/gold-New-England finish; and strong college acceptances including Bowdoin, Colby, Boston University, and Northeastern. The Pre-K lottery process is underway, and two students were competing that day at the state School Nutrition cook-off after winning their regional round.

Key Decisions

✓ No vote — informational report.

Action Items

None.

Old Business

11.1 — 2026–27 School Calendar, Final Approval [18:30]

Discussion Summary

Final approval of the calendar first approved March 11 (no staggered Pre-K/kindergarten start, students beginning Monday, August 31).

Key Decisions

✓ **Approved 7–0.**

Action Items
None.

New Business: FY27 Budget Public Hearing & First Reading

12.1 & 12.2 — Public Hearing on the Proposed FY27 Budget [19:24]

Discussion Summary
The committee recessed into a public hearing on the proposed FY27 budget: $57,349,321.39, a 7.5% increase over FY26 (down from the original 9.88% March 4 proposal), a 7.34% increase to the local tax share. Mayor David Morse spoke during the earlier public-participation period, thanking the committee and anticipating continued City Council support ahead of a June 9 voter referendum. No one spoke in person during the hearing itself, but three written comments were read into the record — one in full support, and two urging the committee to restore funding for two Westbrook Middle School instructional coach positions under consideration for elimination.

Key Decisions
✓ **12.1 (recess into public hearing): approved 7–0.**

✓ **12.2 (close public hearing, return to session): approved 7–0.**

Action Items
None.

Point / Counterpoint

> *"The two instructional coach positions account for less than one-third of one percent of our proposed budget. The cost of keeping them is essentially a rounding error. The cost of losing them, however, would be felt by every teacher and by extension every student in the building...this is a cut we can't afford."*

— Pete Vernon, Westbrook Middle School staff member (written comment) [23:55]

> *"What I observed in rooms with coaches present was collaboration with teachers through modeling and supporting...their guidance is always thoughtful, well-paced, innovative, and extremely helpful."*

— Jacqueline Dimmick, Saccarappa multilingual teacher (written comment) [25:54]

12.3 — Adoption of the FY27 Budget, First Reading (Roll Call Vote) [30:20]

Discussion Summary
Chair Poitras read the full set of state-required budget warrant articles, including the per-category breakdown: regular instruction ($21,712,387.10), special education ($10,633,908.71), career and technical education ($3,433,294.98), other instruction ($847,790.41), student and staff support ($4,600,998.09), system administration ($2,034,810.20), school administration ($2,430,076.55), transportation ($2,705,330.37), facility maintenance ($4,836,685.98), and debt service/other commitments ($4,114,039.09). Chair Mancuso detailed

roughly $1.3 million in total reductions from the original proposal (the increase falling from 9.88% to 7.5%), including seven eliminated/reduced staff positions, $114,000 cut from technology, $60,000-plus from professional development, nearly $20,000 from athletics/activities, and roughly $70,000 from facilities.

Key Decisions

✓ Approved 7–0 by roll call (first reading).

Action Items

None.

Point / Counterpoint

> *"I'm saddened that there was not more public input into our budget...if we don't [hear from the community], we operate off of what's presented to us in a really thoughtful way, but it also...folks lose out on a chance to have a voice in a really transparent, public process."*

— Erin Cavallaro, Board Member (on public engagement) [45:17]

> *"Getting the deep dive look at this, I've been really appreciative of all the work that's been done over several years to get to what is a really responsible budget."*

— Dr. Flynn Ross, Board Member (first budget cycle on the committee) [52:16]

12.4 — Waive Two School Days at Year-End [54:28]

Discussion Summary

The annual routine request: shifts the last day of school from Monday, June 22 to Wednesday, June 17 (both half days), since the calendar includes two more student days than the state minimum. Taken as a combined first-and-final reading.

Key Decisions

✓ Approved 7–0.

Action Items

None.

How this was made

This summary was produced from the meeting video (linked above, hosted on the City's Vimeo showcase). The audio was downloaded with Downie 4 and transcribed with speaker diarization using MacWhisper. Claude (Anthropic's AI) cross-checked names against the official School Committee roster, attributed speakers from context (introductions, roll-call order, direct address by the Chair) rather than the raw diarization labels alone, and drafted this summary and the quoted excerpts. Quotes are lightly cleaned of filler words/false starts but not reworded. Review tier: Not reviewed.

Produced by Westbrook Currents — westbrookcurrents.com